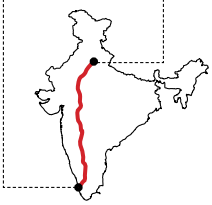
LEVIATHAN OF THE SEAS

FROM ITS GIGANTIC PROPORTIONS TO THE ENGINEERING/ SHIPBUILDING SKILLS THAT WENT INTO MAKING IT, IAC *VIKRANT* IS VERY SPECIAL FOR THE INDIAN NAVY

Graphic by **NILANJAN DAS** | *Text by* **PRADIP R. SAGAR**

2,400 km: length of cables used on *Vikrant*. It could cover the distance between Kochi and Delhi



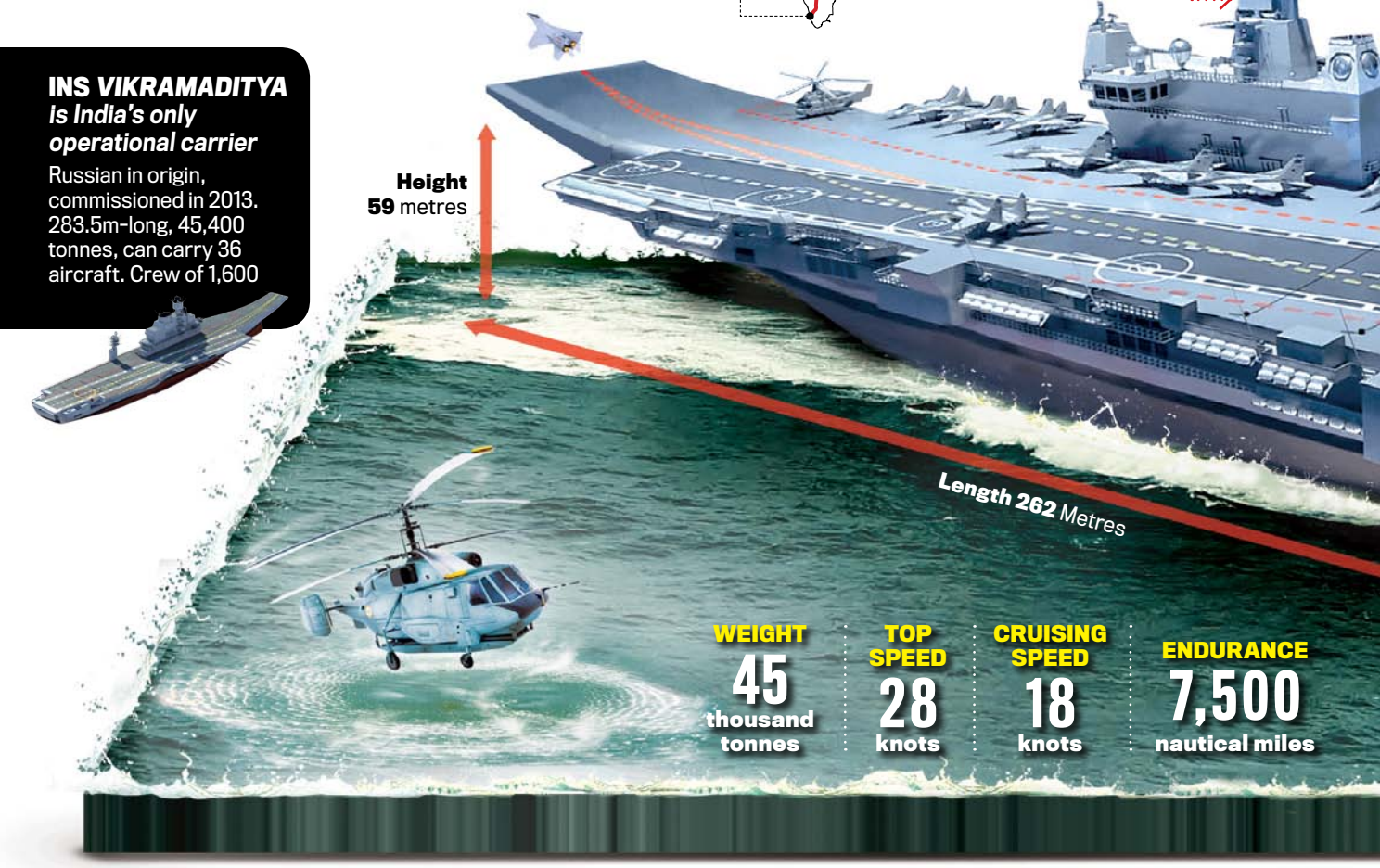
The eight gigantic power generators it uses are enough to light up half of Kochi



The Bridge: The nerve centre of the ship

INS *VIKRAMADITYA* is India's only operational carrier

Russian in origin, commissioned in 2013. 283.5m-long, 45,400 tonnes, can carry 36 aircraft. Crew of 1,600



THE WORLD'S TOP AIRCRAFT CARRIERS

FORD CLASS (US)

Will be the world's biggest carriers, nuclear-powered, load displacement: 100,000 tonnes. Capable of carrying 75 aircraft. Currently in service: one



NIMITZ CLASS (US)

Nuclear-powered and numbering 10, among the world's largest warships; full load displacement: 97,000 tonnes. Capable of carrying over 60 aircraft. The US operates 11 carriers



QUEEN ELIZABETH, (UNITED KINGDOM)

The world's third largest carrier. Full load displacement: 65,000 tonnes. Can carry up to 40 aircraft. The UK has two aircraft carriers



CHARLES DE GAULLE (FRANCE)

The only nuclear-powered carrier outside the US Navy. Full load displacement: 42,000 tonnes. Capable of carrying 40 aircraft. France operates one carrier

